

OE3C Planning Meeting 12 Contents

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OE3C Planning Meeting 12

Meeting Details and Recording Link

Date: 26 Mar 2026

Location: CRN412/Online

Time: 11:04 AM – 12:34 PM

Attendees: Lyllian Corbin, Alex Wilder, Kiyoko Gotanda, Reem Mahamoud, Sarah Hein, Matthew Summerville, Cassia Hamilton, Wylan Clitheroe, Katherine Yagi, Nicholas Benton, Harry Kumbhani, Miriam Richards

Chair: Alex Wilder

Minutes by: Lyllian Corbin

[Recap: OE3C Standing Meeting time Thursday, March 26 | Meeting | Microsoft Teams](#)

Important Notes from Meeting

Post-meeting items for review

- **Registration**
 - Request for reconciliation report before the conference (mid-April)
 - Workshops are to be included on registration page
- **Room Bookings**
 - Awaiting confirmation for Plaza rooms 408 and 411, and MCD room for the April 9th LOC meeting
- **Social Mixer Plans** (for OE3C Participants)
 - Siris Tasting Room (downtown St. Catharines), April 30th, 7:00 pm
 - Selling tickets will cover venue costs for a large-scale event (>40 people)
 - Can downscale to hold mixer in the backroom with no costs
 - Can get vouchers and wine bottles from Siris to give away as prizes
- **Workshops**
 - Hadiya'dagénhahs Centre will hold opening remarks for the conference
 - "Science in Industry and Academia" Panel
 - Professionals from different backgrounds (industry or academia)
- **Photography Contest**
 - Information on OE3C website needs to be updated
 - Submissions will be open until Thursday April 30th
 - Voting will open after Thursday April 30th
- **Merch**
 - Tote bags: Agreed on ordering 200 tote bags to get a discount, will deal with any extras later
 - Alternative: Get 150 bags first and add 50 bags later (*if the local supplier offers tiered/multiple discounts*)
 - Shirts: will be ordered after April 10th
 - Lanyards: work in progress; need envelopes to fit nametags from Alex
 - Notebooks: using PromoCentre (local supplier) for custom notebooks
 - Waiting for sticker quote
- **Catering**
 - Order will cover at least 160 people and up to 200 people
 - Agreed to having the "Fancy Sandwiches" lunch option for all 3 days
- **Banquet**
 - Looking for alternative photo booth companies
 - Alternative entertainment options: DIY photo booth, hiring a photographer, mini golf
- **Crowd-Voting Website**
 - Mock up of website will be set up for the next meeting

Notes for all LOC members

- **Centralise communication on Teams**, in the appropriate thread
- Reach out to other universities and **encourage people to register**
- **Registration deadlines**
 - o Presenters register by: March 29th
 - o Final presenter deadline: April 5th
 - o Final participant deadline: April 10th (registration will be closed)
- Send Nicholas any images to advertise the “Genetic Algorithm” computer science workshop
 - o Send any names of professionals for the science panel
- Send Cassia any information about photo booth companies for the banquet
- **Submit your abstracts to present at OE3C!**
- Leave comments on Crowd-Voting Website **by April 1st**
- Send Rasa any updates that need to be made on the OE3C website

Files and links from meeting

“Abstracts” files

- [Abstract Approval Checklist.xlsx](#)
 - o Spreadsheet to organise reviews for OE3C abstracts

“Catering and Banquet” files

- [OE3C Catering breakdown .pptx](#)
 - o Breakdown of all beverages and food included in the order for breakfast and coffee breaks (morning and afternoon). Includes estimated costs for lunch.

“Outings and Socials” files

- [Siris OE3 Mixer.pptx](#)
 - o Outline of social mixer event plans and estimated costs for Siris Tasting Room. Includes contingency plans if we need to downscale the event.

Other Links

- https://www.amazon.ca/dp/B09WH2KJWB?ref=fed_asin_title&th=1
 - o Example of lanyards (previously ordered for FMS GRaD 2025 conference)
- [OE3C Online platform list.docx](#)
 - o Outline of crowd-voting website participants will use to judge talks during the conference
- https://1drv.ms/w/c/b9d3038016d4ecf6/IQDAmMFRCgbYT6AqMrSMGECKAeKGvFHikcSf_8dpxOoAjuQ?e=xDeebN
 - o Outline of plans for the Science in Industry and Academia panel (includes list of professionals to be invited to the panel)

Meeting Minutes

Call to Order

- Alex started the meeting at 11:04 AM
- **LOC members were requested to centralise communication on Teams in threads to avoid confusion over email**

Registration Update

- From Reem:
 - o 9 people registered and more t-shirt orders were received
 - o Lucas checked reconciliation reports
 - We made a gross of \$2800
 - Lucas can give us an updated value later or the full value after Apr 30th
 - We discussed whether we want another report before conference (mid-April) or by the end of month?
 - o Kiyoko mentioned that we don't need the money asap
 - o Sarah liked the idea of having the report done before the conference – we agreed with this
- From Alex:
 - o Reached out to people at Windsor and invited undergrads to come to OE3C
 - Undergrads will be registering
 - Harry will be reaching out to Waterloo
 - **LOC members – please reach out to other universities you have connections to (you attended there or have friends there) and encourage students to register**
 - o Reminder of registration deadlines:
 - Final presenter deadline is April 5th
 - Final participant deadline is April 10th
 - Registration will be closed on April 10th
 - o Lauren will send registration reminders and invite colleges
 - Wylan confirmed that people from Niagara College and Fleming College will be interested
- ****Workshops to be included on registration page**

Room Bookings

- Kiyoko confirmed the following room bookings are set:
 - o Thistle
 - o Plaza 400 level hallway

- Computer science workshop room
- Photography workshop room
- Kiyoko is still waiting to hear confirmation for the following booking requests:
 - Plaza 408 & 411
 - MCD 3xx room (for April 9th LOC meeting)

Siris Social

- Presentation of event plans in teams: [Siris OE3 Mixer.pptx](#)
- We could sell tickets but will not open the event to all of the Brock community right now (we want to prioritise OE3C participants)
- Bus pass to reach downtown is going to be included on the sponsor package because Niagara Transit is unlikely to help sponsor the costs for complementary passes
- If less than 40 people sign up for the event, we can hold the mixer in the backroom at Siris
 - There is no price commitment if we downscale to this option
- Siris is also a wine store, so we can get vouchers or bottles of wine to give away as prizes
- The social will officially start at 7:00 pm per Margarita's (Siris owner) request
 - The social is scheduled to happen right after the keynote, so people can trickle in

Workshops and Outings Update

- From Nick:
 - Finished workshop content that will be included in the flyers
 - Looking for photos to advertise the workshops, specifically the Genetic Algorithm workshop
 - **LOC members were asked to send any images to Nick**
 - Art Gallery (Willow Art Community or WAC)
 - The WAC will send out a call for artists
 - Lee from WAC suggested inviting students to display art and invite all participating artists to attend the conference
 - Alex explained that we cannot afford to feed them, but they are free to attend the talks
 - Lauren can talk to her sister about showing her art at the gallery
 - Nick will reach out to Brock student artists and other art communities

- From Madelaine:
 - Hadiya'dagénhahs workshop plans
 - Just heard back from someone to hold a meeting, but it has been difficult to get responses from them in a timely manner
 - We agreed to have them do opening remarks instead of a workshop for ease
 - Alex mentioned that Nick had ideas to do a panel in replacement of the workshop
 - Nick: Science in Industry and Academia
 - Outline:
https://1drv.ms/w/c/b9d3038016d4ecf6/IQDAmMFRCgbYT6AqMrSMGECKAeKGvFHikcSf_8dpxOoAjuQ?e=xDeebN
 - Panel will consist of professionals from different backgrounds, some from academia (CCOVI, science stores, professors with ties to the industry or they have a cool history)
 - Kiyoko is part of this list and suggested Fiona Hunter
 - Katherine is also part of this list, and she can talk to her mom about participating too
 - Wylan is interested in being a part of this and may know some people that they can reach out to about the panel
 - Photography contest is live but no submissions yet
 - Kiyoko pointed out that the website needs to be updated – submissions should happen until start of conference and voting should open during conference
 - Nick agreed having the voting only open during the conference so people can see all of the photo submissions beforehand
 - Wylan suggested extending the submissions to end on the first day of the conference since the photography workshop is on the first day
 - Madelaine will make these changes

Merch Update

- We are not opposed to getting tote bags from local supplier
 - Bags can be made in 2 weeks
 - Option A: get 150 bags and buy 50 more later

- Sarah: we could start an order for 150 bags and add 50 later before confirming the purchase
- Option B: get 200 bags for a better discount and risk having more than needed
 - Lauren and Sarah will ask if the tiered discount can be applied to a split order, or we will just order all 200 bags and deal with any extras later
- Lauren will wait to order shirts after April 10th
- Lanyards
 - Campus store will not provide
 - Looking at options on Amazon
 - Kiyoko's example from GRAMSS:
https://www.amazon.ca/dp/B09WH2KJWB?ref=fed_asin_title&th=1
 - Alex already has the nametags; we need to order the lanyards and plastic holders that fit the nametags
- Notebooks
 - Using PromoCentre to make custom notebooks (they are local)
 - Giving a big discount
 - Will have a pen holder and custom recycled pens
 - Waiting for sticker quote
 - We agreed to these options

Catering Update

- [OE3C Catering breakdown .pptx](#)
- Deciding on lunch options
 - We agreed to the fancy sandwiches option for all 3 days (most cost-effective with good choices for the participants)

Banquet Update

- Cassia reached out to company for photo booth
 - Communication issues
 - Travel fee in addition to the quote
 - Axed the company and is looking for another option
 - LOC members were asked to let Cassia know of any companies if they know
 - Alternative options
 - DIY photo booth
 - Katharine has a big golden metal frame that can hold a big poster for the backdrop

- Photographer
- Alex could bring back her brother's mini golf equipment (free of charge)

Abstract Review Committee

- Nick added documents to the Abstracts folder in Files & Documents
 - Abstract Approval Checklist: [Abstract Approval Checklist.xlsx](#)
 - Contains link to abstract
 - Will have 2 reviewers per abstract (already listed on spreadsheet)
 - **LOC members were requested to submit their abstracts for OE3C**

Sponsorships Update

- From Alex:
 - The Botany Journal is offering an open access waiver for the best botany oral presentation talk
 - Liette suggested that talks for this award should be in one section
 - Should also be judged by people in the field, not crowd-voted
 - Picking up 2 gift cards today

Crowd-voting and Voting Website

- [OE3C Online platform list.docx](#)
- From Alex:
 - Users will be tracked so they can't submit multiple times
 - Can be set to identify outlier scores
 - GRAMSS rubrics will be used as a guideline
 - **LOC members were asked to leave any comments by April 1st**
 - Mock up of website will be set up for next meeting

Other Notes and Adjournment

Please send any updates to Rasa.

Meeting adjourned at 12:34 PM.